TL-07

EMERGENCY TOOLS

COMMUNICATION PLAN

A printable family communication and emergency contact plan.

THE BANDWIDTH PRIORITY RULE

During a wide-scale utility collapse, voice networks instantly jam due to high traffic volume. Text messages consume significantly less bandwidth and automatically retry transmission over standard infrastructure nodes. **Always text first. Never make non-essential voice calls.** Keep mobile devices switched into low-power configuration windows.

1. PRIMARY HOUSEHOLD RECORD & OUT-OF-AREA RELAY

Complete these logs using a pen before any active network failure. Identify a remote out-of-area central tracking contact located in an entirely different state who can manage and pass coordinates for separated family members.

Household / Plan Tracking Name: _____

Primary Local Residence Address: _____

Out-of-Area Relay Contact Name: _____

Relay Primary Location / State: _____ | **Relay Phone/SMS:** _____

HOUSEHOLD NODE DIRECTORY

Full Legal Name	Cellular Line / SMS	Primary Workplace / School Location
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

2. REGIONAL ASSEMBLY POINTS & RADIO FREQUENCY COORDINATION

Establish explicit geographical coordinates and physical landmarks where the household will assemble if communication fails entirely or evacuation mandates are enacted.

Rally Point Level	Exact Physical Landmark / Address	Primary Route Variant
Level 1: Immediate Exit (Fire, Gas Leak, Structural)	_____ ___ _____ ___	Direct egress path clear of structures
Level 2: Neighborhood (Grid Failure, Local Evacuation)	_____ ___ _____ ___	_____ _____ _____ _____
Level 3: Out-of-Area (Regional Disruption)	_____ ___ _____ ___	_____ _____ _____ _____

SHORT-RANGE HARDWARE MONITORING FREQUENCIES

When standard cellular infrastructure fails entirely, tactical radio communications take precedence. Utilize the specific Family Radio Service (FRS) or General Mobile Radio Service (GMRS) channel rows documented below to schedule check-in windows.

Radio Service Class	Channel Allocation	Privacy Code / PL Tone	Scheduled Checking Window
Primary Tactical (GMRS/FRS)	Channel _____ (Freq: _____)	Code _____ (Tone: _____ Hz)	Top of every hour (00-05 mins)
Secondary Alternate (FRS)	Channel _____ (Freq: _____)	Code _____ (Tone: _____ Hz)	Mid-hour window (30-35 mins)
Local Area Repeater (GMRS)	Rx: _____ / Tx: _____	Input Tone: _____ Hz	As required for distance relay
Amateur Net Calling (VHF/UHF)	Freq: _____ MHz	Offset / Tone: _____	Emergency net check-in cycle

3. SYSTEM VERIFICATION LOG & MAINTENANCE MONITORING

Test communication hardware and family alignment parameters every six months. Never wait for a catastrophe to verify radio propagation fields or to confirm contact numbers.

Audit Class / Target	Completed Date	Initials	Corrective Adjustments & Battery Updates Executed
SMS Relay Check	_____	_____	_____
Radio Range Verification	_____	_____	_____
Local Area Repeater Test	_____	_____	_____
Contact Ledger Sync	_____	_____	_____

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FIELD SOURCES AND AUTHORITATIVE TECHNICAL REFERENCES

• Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA) / Ready.gov - Family Emergency Communication Planning Standard
• Federal Communications Commission (FCC) / Part 95 - Personal Radio Services Regulatory Rules Framework
• Department of Homeland Security (DHS) - National Emergency Communications Plan (NECP) Directives Matrix